

I use a hosts file from this project:  
<https://github.com/StevenBlack/hosts>.

## DNS

Do not set the DNS servers in your modem configuration to 8.8.8.8 or 8.8.4.4 (both from Google) or 1.1.1.1 (from Cloudflare ~ Amazon). Instead, use the DNS provided by your ISP or from other free DNS services such as Comodo (8.26.56.26 and 8.20.247.20) or OpenDNS (208.67.222.123 and 208.67.220.123). Spread your internet footprint across several providers. Do note that these alternative DNS servers provide family-safe filtered results.

## Chrome alternatives

Sure, there are Chrome alternatives like Opera, Edge, Brave and Vivaldi. When Microsoft Edge made the switch to

Chromium engine, it revealed that it had removed several Google-related dependencies from the open source code. That was quite a long list. ('Microsoft reveals all the Google things it removed in its Chromium Edge browser'; *The Verge*; 2019) Microsoft had its own proprietary replacements. How much did the other Chrome alternatives remove?

In summary, say NO to browser monoculture and use Firefox while you can. 

 By: V. Subhash

The author has written more than two dozen mostly non-fiction books including *FFmpeg Quick Hacks* (to be replaced by *Quick Start Guide To FFmpeg*), *CommonMark Ready Reference*, *Linux Command-Line Tips & Tricks*, *Cool Electronic Projects* and *How To Install Solar*.

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### Concepts related to OA

Access to knowledge movement  
 Creative Commons  
 Directory of Open Access Journals  
 Freedom of information  
 Guerilla Open Access  
 Open access mandate  
 Open access monograph  
 Open Access Scholarly Publishers Association  
 Open Access Week  
 Open data  
 Open educational resources  
 Open government  
 Predatory publishing debate  
 Right to internet access  
 [Source: Wikipedia]

In an online discussion, Francis Jayakanth, one of the active contributors to this space, noted that, to date, about 55,500 Indian Institute of Science (IISc) articles have been uploaded to the IISc's institutional repository, ePrints@IISc ([eprints.iisc.ac.in](http://eprints.iisc.ac.in)). Besides, the IISc has roughly 62K items in the Scopus database, which spans the years 1908 to 2022. So, the ePrints@IISc repository has a bit more than 90 per cent coverage of IISc publications. In terms of full-

### External links

- Open access web archives:  
<https://web.archive.org/web/20110811230254/http://users.ecs.soton.ac.uk/harnad/Hypermail/Amsci/date.html>
- All postings from August 25, 1998 to November 2010 — a total of 8843 messages: <http://mailman.ecs.soton.ac.uk/mailman/listinfo/goal>

text inclusion in the repository, this is believed to be somewhere between 80 and 85 per cent.

Arun argues: "I wish other IR (institutional repository) managers in India make available such information about their repositories. I have often heard that the IISc repository has only metadata (or bibliographic details) and NOT full texts. Also, I have heard people say that it is NOT a genuine OA repository as the content there is not 'author self-archived' but drawn from a database. Does that really matter? As for me, as long as a repository provides the full texts of papers, users need not worry about how they came into the repository in the first place. Yes, it would be ideal if authors self-archive."

He sees his journey promoting OA as having started before 2000, "although I may not have used the term open access. The terms I used in those days (and continue to use till now) are 'access' and 'visibility'."

Some of the problem areas he feels will continue to grow include "commercial publishers bundling journals, and extending their influence to matters concerning research evaluation, academic assessments and 'ranking'." Arun also believes that the "publishing oligarchy" has entrenched itself and is now wielding enormous control and influence and "we (scientists and scholars) are trying to retrieve what is rightfully our territory from the usurpers." 

 By: Frederick Noronha

The author is an independent journalist and publisher, and has written on FOSS for almost two decades.